

India's electronics output surpasses imports

Marking a significant development for India's reputation as a manufacturing hub, the domestic production of electronics has increased past imports for the first time in 2016-17. After oil, it is electronic products imports that put the most significant drain on India's foreign exchange reserves.

Speaking to the *Times of India*, government officials have stated that figures for domestic production of electronic goods for 2016-17 stood

at \$49.5 billion, above the \$43 billion spent on imports. This is probably one of the earliest signs that the Make in India initiative has made some inroads towards improving the state of the domestic manufacturing sector.

Favourable business policies for the domestic electronics sector have undoubtedly played their part, particularly in the manufacturing of smartphones, set-top boxes, televisions and other appliances.

LAVA launches 'Design in India' phone

Marking the start of Indian government's Design in India initiative, LAVA International has launched India's first 'Designed in India' mobile phone. The Design in India initiative was launched recently by Ravi Shankar Prasad, minister of Law & Justice and Information Technology, Government of India, along with other ministers.

Unveiling the initiative, Prasad said, "Our government has put in place policies and structures to fulfil our commitment to make India a global hub of electronics manufacturing, which has led to setting up of 108 mobile manufacturing units in last three years. Design in India is a key milestone in that direction."



LAVA unveils India's first Design in India initiative, giving India its first Designed in India mobile phone

Manoj Sinha, minister of State for Communications (Independent Charge) and minister of State for Railways, government of India, commented, "Our vision is to create 100 million jobs by 2022. Initiatives like

On The Move

Jeff joins Lumileds as SVP

Lumileds has appointed Jeff Henderson as senior vice president of corporate development. Henderson has over 25 years of experience in numerous executive roles. Prior to joining Lumileds, Henderson led corporate development for Keysight Technologies—an electronic equipment, software and services business spun out of Agilent Technologies. Henderson has a BSEE from Auburn University, an MBA from Santa Clara University and an Executive MBA from Boston University, specialising in strategic leadership change.

New GM (Finance) takes charge at BEL

Visvanathan Muralidharan has taken charge as general manager (Finance) at the corporate office of Navratna Defence PSU Bharat Electronics Ltd (BEL). Muralidharan has served BEL in various capacities, handling diverse areas of finance like costing, budgeting, compilation and treasury. He has rich experience in treasury management and handling complex issues with banks/financial institutions and credit rating agencies.

Make in India and Design in India will play a vital role in creating jobs for a young and large country like ours, not just for today but for our future generations as well."

Worldwide semiconductor revenue to grow 7.5 per cent

Worldwide semiconductor revenue will grow 7.5 per cent from \$419 billion in 2017 to total \$451 billion in 2018, forecasts Gartner, Inc.

"Price increases for both DRAM and NAND flash memory are raising the outlook for the overall semiconductor market," said Ben Lee, principal research analyst at Gartner.

However, these price increases

will put pressure on margins for system vendors of key semiconductor demand drivers, including smartphones, PCs and servers. Gartner predicts that component shortages, a rising bill of materials (BOM) and the resulting prospect of having to raise average selling prices (ASPs) will create a volatile market through 2018.

Excluding the memory sectors, the

semiconductor market is forecast to grow 4.6 per cent in 2018 (compared with 9.4 per cent in 2017) with field-programmable gate arrays (FPGAs), optoelectronics, application-specific integrated circuits (ASICs) and non-optical sensors leading the semiconductor device categories.

The other significant device category driving the 2018 forecast higher